of Partition, as well as his response to South African apartheid and the situation of political prisoners are displayed alongside his more abstract and evocative forms. A wall of self-portraits is itself a thoroughly enjoyable and intimate way of getting to know the artist's voice.

The collection also houses the artist's carefully maintained archive of letters, journals, newspaper coverage, poetry and photographs (some delightful ones by his friend Madan Mahatta, like the fish-eye perspective on the artist and his buoyant work, 'Acrobats'). But perhaps what makes this depiction of an artist of a certain time feel so relevant, is the museum team's more recent initiative to include within its ambit the story of Jangpura, the neighbourhood where Sehgal lived and worked for over four decades. The museum is creating a print and digital oral history pieced together from residents of the locality, as well as a calendar of historical, food and photography walks and talks about the area's residents—Hindus, Muslims, Sikhs, Afghans—and its surroundings. In this way, the artist's engagement with his time and place finds continuity in a thriving and diverse community engagement with his life, art and values. ■

–Disha Mullick

Visits to the Amar Nath Sehgal Private collection are by prior intimation only. Please email speak@amarnathsehgal.com or curator@amarnathsehgal.com

GALLERY

For the Love of Horses

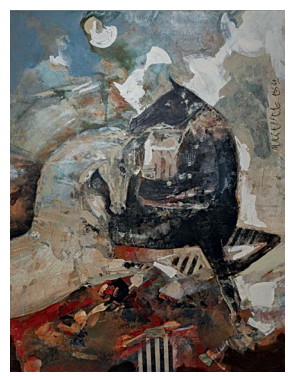
Muzaffar Ali's upcoming exhibition, *Farasnama–The Legend of the Horse*, celebrates the equine figure across mediums

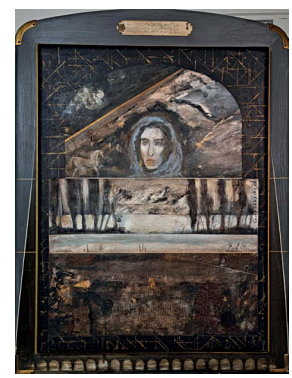
"I have a deep connection with horses," confesses artist and filmmaker Muzaffar Ali, whose upcoming exhibition, *Farasnama–The Legend of the Horse*, scheduled from October 19-28 at Bikaner House's Centre of Contemporary Art (CCA) in Delhi, celebrates his favourite subject. "Faras translates to 'horse' in Urdu. It is the story of the horse and how it becomes a metaphor in my world," he adds. "There's something beyond the back of a horse. It's the loyalty, surrender, love in its eyes...you see these things only if you are face-to-face with it."

The showcase, designed by architect Meera Ali and curator-historian Uma Nair, has 50 pieces of varying sizes, spread between canvases and bronzes. "The aspect of size is interesting; I can go very small or very big. But it's the same horse or landscape," explains Ali.

EQUINE BALANCE
Paintings (all oil on canvas) from Muzaffar Ali's series *Farasnama–The Legend of the Horse*







The exhibition has four sections: Zooni portraits, Equus, sculptures and calligraphy. The Zooni portraits present a nostalgic reflection on a film Ali couldn't finish in Kashmir, starring Dimple Kapadia. "In this series of paintings, I didn't realise, but the horse is standing there. It wasn't intentional," he adds. Equus, on the other hand, features paintings that show his love for equine figures.

Ali's passion for horses spans distinct mediums, with the artist-filmmaker using bronzes for the first time to offer a more tactile and dynamic experience. "When you start doing a bronze, there's a different feel of space. It's a new way of looking at my subject. I don't know how far it will go, but I enjoy working with different materials," he reveals. "I would also like to explore semi-precious stones in the future." The exhibit also includes a series of horse sculptures cast as buckles accompanied by leather belts. "Sometimes, I get so intense that I create a buckle which I wear around my belt. There's a piece of a horse everywhere," says Ali.

The exhibition also features a set of new calligraphy studies. "Calligraphy is a way of expressing the elegance of your thoughts. I don't have a great handwriting, so I collaborate with calligraphers," shares Ali. "I have a symbiotic relationship with co-artists in all my work." ■

–Geetika Sachdev